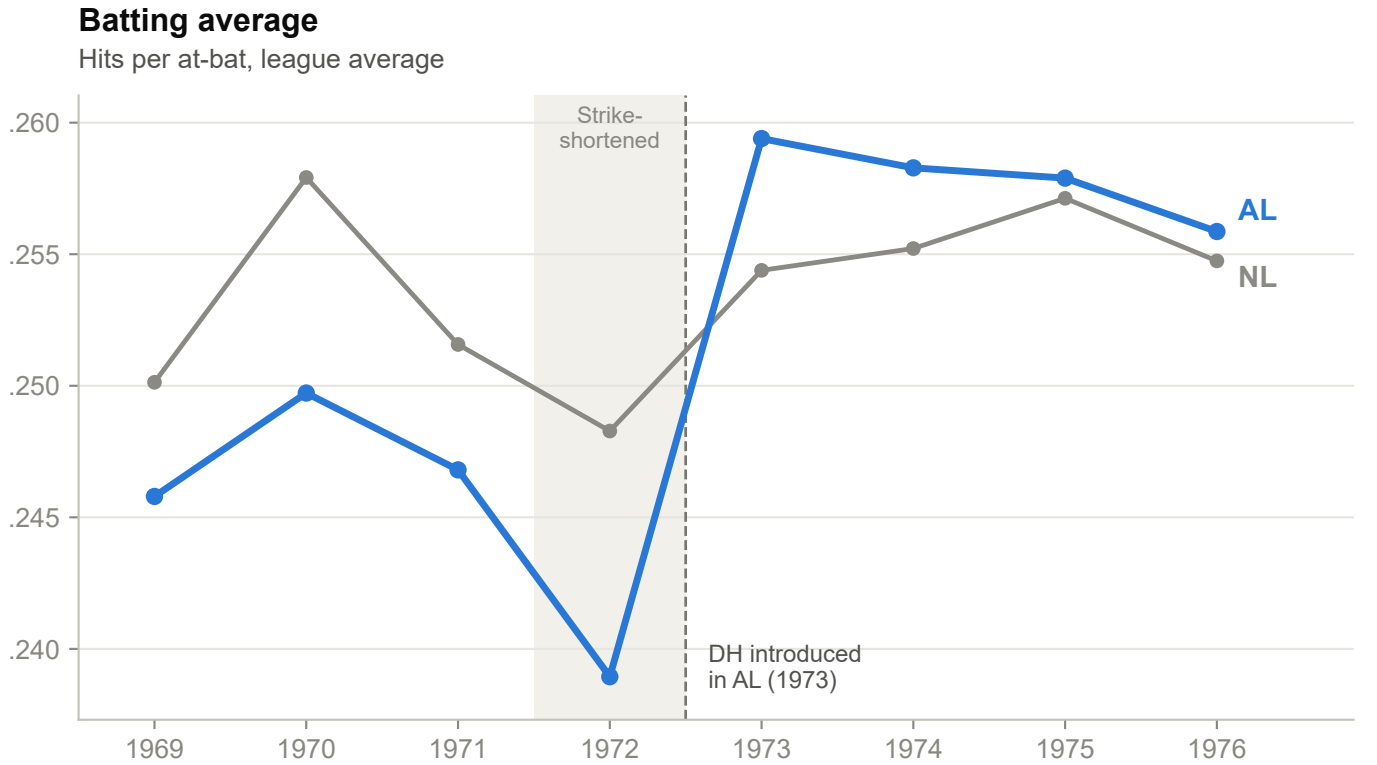
With the DH, the AL went from trailing the NL in batting average every season to leading every season

Yearly league averages, American League (AL, blue) vs. National League (NL, gray), 1969–1976.



Source: SABR Lahman Baseball Database (2025). Notes: Averages are across the 12 teams in each league. 1972 (shaded) was shortened by a player strike; all measures are per game or per at-bat, so seasons remain comparable. Descriptive only; the difference-in-differences estimates give the effect of the DH.